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October 9, 2025

Subject: I-140 Petition for EB-1A (Business) by Amit Kumar

Dear USCIS Officer:

This letter is submitted in support of Amit Kumar ("Beneficiary") as an Alien of Extraordinary Ability in business.

In this petition, we submit probative evidence to demonstrate by a preponderance of the evidence that the Beneficiary is an expert in the field of Cloud Engineering. The evidence demonstrates that the Beneficiary has established a proven record as a leader in this field, and clearly meets at least three (3) regulatory criteria to qualify for EB-1A classification.

I. THE FIELD: Cloud Engineering

Cloud Engineering encompasses the design, implementation, and management of complex distributed computing systems that deliver scalable, reliable, and secure services over the internet. This field combines principles from software engineering, systems architecture, and network infrastructure to create and maintain the foundational technologies that power modern digital transformation across industries.

At its core, Cloud Engineering involves developing and operating distributed computing environments that enable organizations to access computing resources, storage, and applications on-demand without maintaining physical infrastructure. This includes architecting solutions for public, private, and hybrid cloud environments, implementing automated deployment systems, and ensuring high availability and disaster recovery capabilities. The field extends beyond traditional IT infrastructure management to encompass modern practices such as Infrastructure as Code (IaC), containerization, and microservices architecture.

The field continues to evolve rapidly with the emergence of edge computing, serverless architectures, and multi-cloud strategies. These developments create new demands for innovative solutions in areas such as automated scaling, real-time data processing, and intelligent resource management. As organizations increasingly rely on cloud services for their critical operations, Cloud Engineering professionals must navigate challenges related to system scalability, data privacy, regulatory compliance, and cross-platform compatibility while ensuring seamless integration with existing enterprise systems.

Cloud Engineering stands as a cornerstone of modern technological infrastructure, playing a vital role in maintaining the United States' position as a global leader in digital innovation. This field is fundamental to the nation's digital transformation efforts, enabling organizations across all sectors - from healthcare and financial services to government agencies and defense - to build resilient, scalable, and secure digital infrastructures. The strategic importance of Cloud Engineering extends beyond individual business operations, directly impacting national security, economic competitiveness, and critical infrastructure protection.

In the context of national security, Cloud Engineering provides the foundation for modern defense systems, enabling rapid deployment of mission-critical applications, secure data storage, and advanced analytics capabilities essential for intelligence operations. The field's importance to critical infrastructure protection is paramount, as it enables the development of robust disaster recovery systems, ensures business continuity, and strengthens cyber resilience across vital sectors of the American economy.

Cloud Engineering drives economic growth and innovation throughout the United States by enabling organizations to modernize their operations, reduce capital expenditure, and scale efficiently. The field directly contributes to job creation and economic development while facilitating the advancement of emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence, machine learning, and edge computing. These capabilities are essential for maintaining U.S. technological leadership in an increasingly competitive global landscape.

Furthermore, Cloud Engineering's significance extends to environmental sustainability and resource optimization, as cloud technologies enable more efficient use of computing resources and reduce energy consumption. This alignment with environmental goals while supporting technological advancement demonstrates the field's crucial role in addressing both immediate and long-term national priorities, positioning it as an essential driver of sustainable digital transformation in the modern era.

II. THE BENEFICIARY: Amit Kumar

Mr. Kumar brings over 20 years of distinguished experience in software engineering and cloud architecture, supported by advanced academic credentials including a Master of Computer Applications (2004) and Bachelor of Science (2001) from Kurukshetra University, India. His career trajectory demonstrates consistent progression from early software engineering roles in India's technology sector to increasingly senior positions with major U.S. corporations. Beginning as a Programme Assistant at NIELIT, a prestigious Indian government technology institution, Mr. Kumar advanced through technical leadership positions at global firms including HCL America, Boeing, and Elsevier, before assuming his current role as Principal Software Engineer at AT&T. Throughout his career, Mr. Kumar has developed specialized expertise in cloud engineering and distributed systems architecture, leading mission-critical digital initiatives that serve millions of users across enterprise and telecommunications sectors.

In his current position at AT&T, Mr. Kumar has demonstrated exceptional technical leadership by architecting mission-critical platforms that serve millions of users, including the AT&T Internet Air platform which grew to over 650,000 subscribers. His innovative contributions have resulted in significant business impact, including a 36% reduction in infrastructure costs through cloud migration initiatives and a 30% improvement in conversion rates through performance optimization. This expertise has been recognized through multiple Connection Awards from AT&T, his selection as a

SAS Eminent Fellow Member, and invitations to serve as Session Chair for IEEE conferences and judge for the Claro Awards for Technical Excellence. Beyond his technical implementations, Mr. Kumar has advanced the field through scholarly articles published in professional publications such as HACKREAD and The AI Journal, where he has shared insights on distributed systems architecture and AI-integrated development. As documented extensively below, Mr. Kumar's contributions to cloud engineering and distributed systems architecture are widely recognized, and he continues to drive technological innovation in this domain through his leadership of strategic initiatives and active participation in professional technical communities.

III. EB-1A ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

1. Documentation of the Beneficiary's membership in associations in the field for which the classification is sought that requires outstanding achievement of their members, as judged by recognized national or international experts in the field

a. Scholars Academic and Scientific Society (SAS Society) - SAS Eminent Fellow Member (SEFM)

Mr. Kumar holds the prestigious SAS Eminent Fellow Membership (SEFM) in the Scholars Academic and Scientific Society, an international organization established in 2011 dedicated to academic and scientific integration. The Society, which is formally registered under the Society Registration Act XXI of 1860 in India, advances the field through journal publications, book releases, and international conference organizations. Mr. Kumar's Eminent Fellow membership, granted on September 5, 2025, represents a distinguished tier of recognition within the organization, awarded in acknowledgment of his outstanding contributions to education and research. His membership was formally conferred by the Society's executive committee, including President Dr. Mohammed Imam Uddin and Director Dr. Md. Habibur Rahman, demonstrating the institutional weight of this recognition.

This SEFM designation is not a standard membership but rather an advanced, merit-based tier that requires approval by the society's executive committee, composed of distinguished leaders holding doctoral degrees. Members with this elite status receive several exclusive privileges unavailable to general members, including exemptions from registration fees for the society's annual international awards, up to 50% waivers on publication fees in the society's journals, and special consideration for editorial positions. Additionally, SEFM members are authorized to use the designation after their name and are granted unique opportunities to lead society activities, including hosting international seminars, conferences, and award functions. These exclusive benefits reflect Mr. Kumar's recognized expertise and standing within the academic community.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's selection as an SAS Eminent Fellow Member (SEFM) of the Scholars Academic and Scientific Society, please see:

1. **Exhibit B1:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's prestigious SAS Eminent Fellow Membership (SEFM) with the Scholars Academic and Scientific Society.
 2. **Exhibit B2:** Membership certificate documenting Mr. Kumar's selective SAS Eminent Fellow status in the Scholars Academic and Scientific Society.
 3. **Exhibit B3:** Documentation of a SAS Eminent Fellow Membership offer from the Scholars Academic and Scientific Society to the beneficiary, recognizing his "immense contributions in academics and research" with lifetime validity as signed by the organization's President.
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Based on Mr. Kumar's distinguished membership as an SAS Eminent Fellow Member in the Scholars Academic and Scientific Society, which recognizes only those with outstanding achievements in their respective fields, the discussion above and the documents contained herein demonstrate by a preponderance of the evidence that Mr. Kumar meets the criteria set forth in 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(ii).

2. Evidence of the Beneficiary's participation, either individually or on a panel, as a judge of the work of others in the same or an allied field of specification for which classification is sought

a. Peer Reviewer for the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025)

Mr. Kumar has served as a peer reviewer for the 2025 International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025), a prestigious academic conference jointly organized by BITS Pilani Dubai Campus and the Indian Institute of Information Technology Allahabad. In this capacity, he evaluated approximately twelve research papers spanning diverse artificial intelligence applications, including AI-powered legal documentation systems, healthcare chatbots, business intelligence solutions, and crime detection systems. The conference maintains high academic standards through its association with Springer's Lecture Notes in Networks and Systems (LNNS) series, where accepted papers are published. Mr. Kumar conducted comprehensive technical evaluations using structured criteria to assess overall quality, originality, methodology, and conference alignment, providing detailed feedback that directly influenced publication decisions. His expertise and judging contributions were specifically recognized by the organizing committee, who acknowledged that his "prompt, insightful, and constructive feedback played a crucial role in upholding the academic quality and credibility of the conference." This peer review role demonstrates Mr. Kumar's recognized authority to evaluate scholarly work in cloud engineering and related fields, as evidenced by his selection to judge papers for publication in this prestigious international venue.

As a Program Committee Member and Reviewer for ICAIN-2025, which took place October 6-7, 2025, in Dubai, UAE, Mr. Kumar's evaluation responsibilities included conducting comprehensive technical reviews using structured assessment criteria. Among the scholarly works he evaluated were papers titled: "AI powered Legal Documentation Assistant," "From Queries to Insights: An AI-Powered Chatbot for Modern Universities," "A Hybrid AI Chatbot for Mental Health Support Using Gemini API with Ethical Safeguards," "MediAI: An AI-Powered Chatbot for Enhancing Healthcare Systems," "AI-Driven Business Intelligence: Redefining Predictive Analytics for Growth in Dynamic Markets," "Image-Aided Stress Monitoring for Students Using AI," "PricePulse: AI-Powered Dynamic Pricing System for E-Commerce," and "AI-Driven Optimal Management of EV Charging Using Dynamic Pricing and Predictive Maintenance." His reviews encompassed papers from multiple specialized conference tracks including "Artificial Intelligence for Sustainable Solutions," "Advances in Computational Intelligence and NLP," "AI for Advance Predictive Analytics," and "AI in Disease Diagnosis, Prediction, and Prevention."

The International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025) maintains significant academic prestige through its association with Springer, one of the world's leading academic publishers. All accepted papers are published in Springer's Lecture Notes in Networks and Systems (LNNS) series (ISSN: 2367-3389; 2367-3370), a well-established venue for disseminating research in networks and systems. The conference's distinguished status is further evidenced by its

organization through a collaboration of prestigious academic institutions, including BITS Pilani Dubai Campus, the Indian Institute of Information Technology Allahabad, and Universal Inovators in Delhi, India. This international scope demonstrates the conference's broad reach and impact across multiple countries. The conference is led by prominent academic officials, including Conference Chair Prof. Sujala D. Shetty (Head of Computer Science at BITS Pilani Dubai Campus), Organizing Chair Dr. Anupam Agrawal (Professor & Dean at IIIT Allahabad), and Publication Chair Prof. Abhishek Swaroop, underscoring its academic rigor and institutional recognition. ICAIN-2025 features specialized technical sessions focusing on cutting-edge research areas such as "AI for Advanced Predictive Analytics," "Current Trends in NLP," and "Artificial Intelligence for Sustainable Solutions," reflecting its commitment to advancing knowledge in emerging technologies and maintaining high academic standards in the field.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's role as a peer reviewer for the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025), please see:

4. **Exhibit C1:** Certificate from ICAIN-2025 confirming Mr. Kumar's service as a scholarly reviewer for the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking.
 5. **Exhibit C2:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the ICAIN conference paper "AI powered Legal Documentation Assistant."
 6. **Exhibit C3:** Screenshot from Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit demonstrating Mr. Kumar's peer review assignments for 12 research papers at the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking 2025 (ICAIN2025).
 7. **Exhibit C4:** Documentation of peer review service for the ICAIN2025 conference affiliated with Springer's Lecture Notes in Networks and Systems series.
 8. **Exhibit C5:** Peer review documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's service as reviewer for AI-powered chatbot paper at the ICAIN Conference.
 9. **Exhibit C6:** A peer review assessment for the ICAIN2025 conference demonstrating the beneficiary's role as a scholarly reviewer who provided critical evaluation and detailed recommendations for a research paper on AI-powered dynamic pricing systems.
 10. **Exhibit C7:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's service as peer reviewer for "Digital Democracy: Building an Online Voting System Using PHP" at the ICAIN conference.
 11. **Exhibit C8:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the ICAIN conference on an AI chatbot research paper.
 12. **Exhibit C9:** Documentation of Mr. Kumar's peer review for the ICAIN conference of "MediAI: An AI-Powered Chatbot for Enhancing Healthcare Systems" research paper.
 13. **Exhibit C10:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the ICAIN2025 conference proceedings published in Springer's Lecture Notes in Networks and Systems series.
 14. **Exhibit C11:** Conference Management Toolkit dashboard documenting Mr. Kumar's peer review service for 11 research papers at the ICAIN2025 academic conference.
 15. **Exhibit C12:** Appreciation letter from the ICAIN 2025 organizing committee confirming Mr. Kumar's service as peer reviewer for ten research papers published in Springer's academic series.
 16. **Exhibit C13:** Email notification confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for ICAIN2025 conference paper on AI-Driven Business Intelligence for Springer LNNS publication.
 17. **Exhibit C14:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the 2025 International Conference on Applied Intelligence and Next-Generation Computing (ICAIN).
 18. **Exhibit C15:** Documentation of Mr. Kumar's peer review service for ICAIN2025 conference, evaluating an AI-based stress monitoring paper for Springer LNNS publication.
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19. **Exhibit C16:** Email confirmation of Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the ICAIN2025 conference, evaluating an AI-powered dynamic pricing system research paper.
20. **Exhibit C17:** Email invitation from Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit confirming Mr. Kumar's selection as peer reviewer for the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025).
21. **Exhibit C18:** Peer review invitation from the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025) requesting Mr. Kumar to evaluate a scholarly paper on AI-driven business intelligence.
22. **Exhibit C19:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networks (ICAIN2025) Springer proceedings.
23. **Exhibit C20:** Invitation email from Microsoft CMT requesting Mr. Kumar to serve as a peer reviewer for the 2025 International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025).
24. **Exhibit C21:** Documentation of Mr. Kumar's peer review service for research paper "AI-Driven Optimal Management of EV Charging Using Dynamic Pricing and Predictive Maintenance" at the conference session on AI for Advance Predictive Analytics.
25. **Exhibit C22:** Documentation of Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the ICAIN2025 conference associated with Springer's Lecture Notes in Networks and Systems series.
26. **Exhibit C23:** Peer review invitation from ICAIN-2025 requesting Mr. Kumar to evaluate Paper #448 on AI-powered dynamic pricing systems.
27. **Exhibit C24:** Email invitation from the International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Networking (ICAIN-2025) confirming Mr. Kumar's selection as peer reviewer for a scholarly paper on AI-based stress monitoring systems.
28. **Exhibit C25:** A peer review evaluation document demonstrating that the Beneficiary served as a scholarly reviewer for a paper submission titled "Power of AI Against Different Adversaries on Web, Country and the Digital World," which addressed AI cybersecurity and adversarial threats in the digital domain.

b. Peer Reviewer for the IEEE International Conference on Recent Trends in Computing and Smart Mobility (RCSM 2025)

Mr. Kumar served as a peer reviewer for the 2025 IEEE International Conference on Recent Trends in Computing and Smart Mobility (RCSM 2025), where he evaluated ten technical papers covering artificial intelligence, web security, deep neural networks, and other computing topics directly related to his expertise in cloud engineering. As a Program Committee Member and Reviewer, his responsibilities included conducting comprehensive technical reviews using a structured four-section evaluation format, analyzing papers' methodologies, technical merit, and research contributions.

Through the Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit platform, Mr. Kumar reviewed several significant papers including "CASSPNet: Continual Authentication through Sensor and Scroll Patterns for Intrusion Prevention in Mobile Applications," "Centralized Configuration Management in Microservices Architectures: A Comprehensive Analysis of Config Server Implementation and Its Impact on System Scalability," "RESPONSIVE WEB INTERFACE DESIGN USING CSS: A PRACTICAL APPROACH," "Suicidal Ideation Detection from Twitter using Web Scrapping, NLP and ML," "Detecting Low-Credibility Medical Websites Using TF-IDF Vectorization and Random Forest Classification," "A Hybrid LeNet-U-Net Architecture for Low-Light Image Enhancement," "An Enhanced and Intelligent Deep Neural Network technique for Web Data Security," and "Web-Based Intelligent Alert System for Real Time Medication Monitoring and Patient Safety." For each

submission, Mr. Kumar provided detailed technical evaluations covering methodology, research contribution, technical specifications, and implementation details, ultimately rendering authoritative decisions on manuscript acceptance or rejection that directly influenced the conference's scholarly publication process. His thorough reviews and constructive feedback were specifically acknowledged by the conference organizing committee as instrumental in maintaining rigorous academic standards, and his contribution was formally recognized through a Certificate of Appreciation from the conference.

The RCSM 2025 conference, assigned IEEE conference number #67767, represents a prestigious academic venue for computing research. It is organized by the Department of Computer Science and Engineering at Maulana Azad National Institute of Technology (MANIT) Bhopal, India, in collaboration with Thapar University, both recognized centers of technical excellence. As an official IEEE conference, RCSM 2025 maintains the rigorous academic standards expected of IEEE-sponsored events and benefits from the organization's global recognition in technology and engineering fields. The conference's international scope is evidenced by its designation as an IEEE International Conference, attracting participants and research contributions from multiple countries. It brings together researchers, academicians, industry professionals, and students to share innovations and research findings related to state-of-the-art developments in computing and smart mobility, with particular alignment to major technological initiatives including Industry 4.0.

Like other top IEEE conferences, RCSM 2025 follows IEEE's established practices for selecting qualified peer reviewers who can provide expert evaluation of technical submissions. Mr. Kumar's selection as a reviewer for multiple papers spanning artificial intelligence, web security, deep neural networks, and other computing topics demonstrates that the conference organizers recognized his broad technical expertise and ability to evaluate cutting-edge research in cloud engineering and related fields. The international scope of the conference and its IEEE affiliation further underscore that reviewers are chosen from among recognized experts capable of maintaining high academic standards in computing and smart mobility technologies.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's service as a peer reviewer for the IEEE International Conference on Recent Trends in Computing and Smart Mobility (RCSM 2025), please see:

29. **Exhibit D1:** Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit (CMT) documentation showing Mr. Kumar's peer review activities for approximately 10 technical papers at the RCSM2025 academic conference.
 30. **Exhibit D2:** Email notification from Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for a mobile authentication technologies paper at the RCSM2025 conference.
 31. **Exhibit D3:** Documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the RCSM conference paper on centralized configuration management in microservices architectures.
 32. **Exhibit D4:** Microsoft CMT notification confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the RCSM2025 conference on responsive web interface design using CSS.
 33. **Exhibit D5:** Microsoft CMT system documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the RCSM2025 conference.
 34. **Exhibit D6:** Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit email confirmation dated August 22, 2025, documenting Mr. Kumar's peer review service for Paper #212 at the RCSM2025 conference.
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35. **Exhibit D7:** Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the paper "A Hybrid LeNet-U-Net Architecture for Low-Light Image Enhancement" at RSCSM2025 conference.
36. **Exhibit D8:** Email confirmation of Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the RSCSM2025 conference on microservices architecture.
37. **Exhibit D9:** Certificate of Appreciation confirming Mr. Kumar's service as peer reviewer for the 2025 IEEE International Conference on Recent Trends in Computing and Smart Mobility.
38. **Exhibit D10:** Email correspondence and certificate from IEEE confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the 2025 Recent Trends in Computing and Smart Mobility Conference (RSCSM).
39. **Exhibit D11:** Conference Management Toolkit (CMT) documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's service as peer reviewer for ten academic papers at the RSCSM2025 research conference.
40. **Exhibit D12:** Microsoft CMT system notification confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review of a research paper on deep neural networks for web data security for the RSCSM2025 academic conference.
41. **Exhibit D13:** Peer review documentation showing the Beneficiary's evaluation of a research paper submission titled "Responsive Web Interface Design Using CSS: A Practical Approach" for the RSCSM publication, where the Beneficiary provided a comprehensive technical assessment and rejection recommendation based on identified deficiencies in the work.
42. **Exhibit D14:** Documentation from Microsoft Conference Management Toolkit confirming Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the RSCSM2025 academic conference.
43. **Exhibit D15:** Official IEEE invitation email confirming Mr. Kumar's selection as peer reviewer for the 1st IEEE International Conference on Recent Trends in Computing and Smart Mobility (RSCSM 2025).

c. Judge for the 2025 Claro Awards for Tech Excellence

Mr. Kumar served as a verified judge for the 2025 Claro Awards for Tech Excellence, a prestigious technology awards program that recognizes outstanding achievements in the technology sector. The Claro Awards implements a rigorous selection process for judges, requiring a minimum of five years of experience in Technology, AI, or Data Analytics fields, along with prior judging experience. Following a multi-step verification process that included profile verification and LinkedIn review, Mr. Kumar was formally selected to evaluate technical submissions. His selection demonstrates that his professional background and technical expertise met these demanding qualification standards, confirming his recognized authority to assess technical excellence in fields allied to cloud engineering.

In his capacity as a judge, Mr. Kumar evaluated 20 nominations showcasing technological innovation and entrepreneurship across multiple emerging technology sectors, including artificial intelligence, healthtech, and climatetech. His role required implementing a structured evaluation methodology, where he assessed each submission across four distinct criteria: Innovation (uniqueness and originality of approach), Methodology (significance of challenges addressed and alignment with industry needs), Execution (quality and technical excellence of implementation), and Results (measurable impact and outcomes achieved). For each criterion, Mr. Kumar provided detailed ratings on a scale of 1-10, which contributed to a composite overall rating for each submission. For instance, in his evaluation of the "Vitamin CS Coaching" project focused on startup transformation, he demonstrated consistent analytical rigor by assigning ratings of 8 out of 10 across all evaluation criteria, resulting in a comprehensive assessment score of 8.0/10. His evaluations directly influenced the selection of award winners.

The Claro Awards maintains stringent selection criteria for its technology judges through a comprehensive four-step selection process. This process ensures that only individuals with distinguished standing in their respective technical fields are approved to evaluate submissions. The organization's structured approach includes provisional selection based on profile details, verification of eligibility through LinkedIn profile review, and careful alignment of judging assignments with each judge's specific area of expertise. This is particularly evident in their practice of matching judges' specialized knowledge with relevant evaluation tasks, as confirmed by their statement that "Once verified, you will receive judging assignments aligned with your expertise." The judging platform specifically matched Mr. Kumar's expertise with relevant evaluation tasks, requiring him to assess projects related to technology innovation, entrepreneurship scaling, and global impact across various tech sectors.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's service as a judge for the 2025 Claro Awards for Tech Excellence, please see:

44. **Exhibit E1:** Documentation from CLARO Awards judging platform confirming Mr. Kumar's service as a verified judge for technology innovation and entrepreneurship projects.
45. **Exhibit E2:** Certificate of Participation confirming Mr. Kumar's service as a judge for the 2025 Claro Awards For Tech Excellence.
46. **Exhibit E3:** Confirmation documentation from the Claro Awards technology excellence platform verifying Mr. Kumar's selection as a judge following their verification process.
47. **Exhibit E4:** Confirmation email from Claro Awards verifying Mr. Kumar's approval as a judge for their technical excellence competition.
48. **Exhibit E5:** Email confirmation from Claro Awards documenting Mr. Kumar's service as judge for the 2025 Claro Awards for Tech Excellence, evaluating 20 technical nominations.
49. **Exhibit E6:** Selection criteria documentation establishing Mr. Kumar's role as a judge for the Claro Awards Technology category.
50. **Exhibit E7:** LinkedIn announcement confirming Mr. Kumar's selection as a judge for the 2025 Claro Awards for Tech Excellence.

d. Session Chair for the IEEE 2nd International Conference on Information Technology, Electronics and Intelligent Communication Systems (ICITEICS 2025)

Mr. Kumar was invited to serve as Session Chair at the IEEE 2nd International Conference on Information Technology, Electronics and Intelligent Communication Systems (ICITEICS 2025), held at the Vemana Institute of Technology in Bengaluru, India on August 30-31, 2025. The conference, co-sponsored by the prestigious IEEE Bangalore Section, represents a distinguished international forum for advancing technology in information systems, electronics, and intelligent communications. As Session Chair for Track A2, Mr. Kumar was specifically selected based on his "pioneering research and significant contributions in the academics/software industry," demonstrating recognition of his expertise to evaluate others' work.

In this capacity, Mr. Kumar was responsible for moderating technical sessions and assessing the quality of research presentations from international participants. His role required him to exercise expert judgment in evaluating the technical merit and significance of submitted work in areas directly aligned with his cloud engineering expertise, including information technology, electronics, and intelligent communication systems. Mr. Kumar leveraged his specialized knowledge in cloud

engineering and distributed systems to provide authoritative assessments of the presented research, ensuring that only work meeting rigorous technical standards received positive evaluation.

The IEEE 2nd International Conference on Information Technology, Electronics and Intelligent Communication Systems derives its prestige primarily from its affiliation with the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE), the world's largest technical professional organization with over 400,000 members globally. IEEE is internationally recognized as the premier organization for advancing technology innovation and excellence in electrical engineering, electronics, and computer science. The conference's technical co-sponsorship by the IEEE Bangalore Section ensures adherence to IEEE's rigorous quality standards. ICITEICS 2025's international scope is evidenced by its multi-organizational support structure and global participation, bringing together researchers and practitioners from around the world. The conference's academic credibility is further enhanced by its institutional backing from the Vemana Institute of Technology and leadership from established professionals in the field, including Dr. Vijayasimha Reddy B.G as General Chair and Prof. Ankitha A as Convener.

The selection of Mr. Kumar as Session Chair reflects the conference's rigorous standards for identifying qualified judges. The invitation letter from R. Vijaya Lakshmi, Assistant Professor at Vemana Institute of Technology, specifically identified Mr. Kumar as "an ideal choice to share insights and inspire the researchers," demonstrating that his appointment was based on demonstrated expertise and accomplishments in the field. This recognition is particularly significant given IEEE's reputation for maintaining high technical standards and the conference's focus on areas that directly align with Mr. Kumar's specialized knowledge in Cloud Engineering. His selection to evaluate others' work at this prestigious international forum provides compelling evidence of his standing as an expert whose opinions on innovation in the field are highly valued.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's role as Session Chair for the IEEE 2nd International Conference on Information Technology, Electronics and Intelligent Communication Systems (ICITEICS 2025), please see:

51. **Exhibit F1:** IEEE invitation letter confirming Mr. Kumar's selection as Session Chair for ICITEICS 2025.
52. **Exhibit F2:** Certificate of Appreciation confirming Mr. Kumar's service as Session Chair at the 2025 IEEE 2nd International Conference on Information Technology, Electronics and Intelligent Communication Systems.
53. **Exhibit F3:** Screenshot from a virtual meeting interface displaying a presentation slide for the 2025 2nd International Conference on Information Technology, Electronics and Intelligent Communication Systems, featuring presenter Hatesh Shyan from Chandigarh University.
54. **Exhibit F4:** IEEE ICITEICS 2025 conference documentation confirming Mr. Kumar's appointment as Session Chair at this prestigious IEEE Bangalore Section co-sponsored event.
55. **Exhibit F5:** Screenshot documenting Mr. Kumar's participation in the IEEE ICITEICS 2025 conference planning session.
56. **Exhibit F6:** Meeting screenshot documenting Mr. Kumar's participation in discussions for the IEEE ICITEICS-2025 Conference, an international conference co-sponsored by IEEE Bangalore Section.

For additional documentation of the Beneficiary's participation as a judge of others' work in the field, please see:

57. **Exhibit G1:** A peer review notification from Microsoft CMT regarding the beneficiary's paper submission titled "From Queries to Insights: An AI-Powered Chatbot for Modern Universities" to the ICAIN2025 conference, which was rejected with detailed reviewer feedback on the hybrid chatbot architecture implementation.
 58. **Exhibit G2:** Documentation of Mr. Kumar's peer review service for the International Conference on AI Innovations (ICAIN2025) using Microsoft's Conference Management Toolkit for Springer-affiliated publications.
 59. **Exhibit G3:** A peer review document demonstrating the beneficiary's evaluation of an academic research paper on continual authentication using quantum neural networks, providing a "Strong Accept" recommendation for the scholarly work submitted for publication consideration.
 60. **Exhibit G4:** Documentation of Mr. Kumar's peer review and acceptance decision for the research paper "An Enhanced and Intelligent Deep Neural Network technique for Web Data Security."
 61. **Exhibit G5:** Peer review documentation demonstrating that the beneficiary served as a scholarly reviewer for a research paper on detecting low-credibility medical websites using machine learning techniques, providing detailed technical evaluation and recommendations.
 62. **Exhibit G6:** Documentation of a peer review conducted for an academic research paper titled "A Hybrid LeNet-U-Net Architecture for Low-Light Image Enhancement" (Paper ID: 88), which demonstrates scholarly evaluation activity including assessment of methodology, performance metrics, and recommendations for improvement.
 63. **Exhibit G7:** Email notification from Microsoft CMT dated August 22, 2025, containing a reviewer's evaluation and rejection of the beneficiary's paper titled "Personal Contact Management with Relationship Visualization: An Adjacency List Approach" submitted to the RSCSM2025 conference.
 64. **Exhibit G8:** Documentation of a peer review conducted for a research paper titled "Web-Based Intelligent Alert System for Real Time Medication Monitoring and Patient Safety" (Paper ID: 91), which evaluates the proposed medical reminder system and concludes with a recommendation to accept the paper for publication.
 65. **Exhibit G9:** Documentation of a peer review conducted for an academic paper titled "Personal Contact Management with Relationship Visualization: An Adjacency List Approach" (Paper ID: 208), demonstrating the beneficiary's service as a scholarly reviewer who provided detailed technical evaluation and ultimately recommended rejection based on identified shortcomings in the paper's methodology and presentation.
 66. **Exhibit G10:** Screenshot of a virtual IEEE Bangalore technical presentation on hyperspectral imaging delivered by Sagnik Patra during a Google Meet session with multiple participants visible.
 67. **Exhibit G11:** Screenshot of a Google Meet video conference showing a research presentation by Thanishka Jonnala on autonomous mobile robotics and TurtleBot3 navigation systems during an IEEE session, with the beneficiary participating as an attendee in the virtual conference.
 68. **Exhibit G12:** Video conference documentation showing participation in an IEEE-affiliated technical presentation on autonomous navigation algorithms for robots during a professional meeting session.
 69. **Exhibit G13:** Presentation screenshot from IEEE Bangalore Section event featuring "Robotics Methodology" by Rishitha M.
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Based on the evidence presented, Mr. Kumar has demonstrated significant involvement in judging the work of others through his roles as a peer reviewer for prestigious international conferences, session chair for IEEE ICITEICS 2025, and judge for industry awards in cloud technology. The discussion above and the documents contained herein demonstrate by a preponderance of the evidence that Mr. Kumar meets the criteria set forth in 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(iv).

3. Evidence of the Beneficiary's authorship of scholarly articles in the field, in professional or major trade publications or other major media

a. Publications in HACKREAD

Mr. Kumar has authored scholarly articles in his field of Cloud Engineering, publishing technical work that addresses complex architectural challenges and implementation strategies for enterprise-scale cloud systems. His December 2023 publication in HACKREAD titled "Architecting Resilient Distributed Front-Ends: Accessibility and Internationalization by Design" demonstrates deep technical expertise in cloud engineering and distributed systems architecture.

This scholarly article was written specifically for learned persons in the field, containing comprehensive technical references and detailed discussions of advanced topics including distributed front-end architecture, accessibility compliance standards (WCAG, ADA, EN 301 549), and cloud-native implementation patterns. The publication effectively bridges theoretical frameworks with practical applications, drawing from Mr. Kumar's experience leading large-scale cloud migration projects at AT&T that impacted hundreds of thousands of users.

As sole author of this work, Mr. Kumar substantively contributes to the field's understanding of implementing resilient cloud architectures while maintaining accessibility and internationalization standards. This makes his publication a valuable scholarly resource for experienced software engineers and architects in the cloud engineering domain.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's published articles in HACKREAD, please see:

- 70. **Exhibit H1:** Bibliography of Mr. Kumar's four cloud engineering articles published in specialized technology platforms between December 2023 and September 2025.
- 71. **Exhibit H2:** Technical article by Mr. Kumar titled "Architecting Resilient Distributed Front-Ends: Accessibility and Internationalization by Design," published in HACKREAD (December 18, 2023).

b. Publications in BestForAndroid

Mr. Kumar has authored scholarly articles that demonstrate his expertise in Cloud Engineering and contribute to the advancement of knowledge in his field. His publication "Advancing Hyper-Scalable Web Systems Through Event-Driven Distributed Architecture," published on BestForAndroid in May 2024, presents a comprehensive analysis of modern cloud architecture approaches and scalability solutions. This scholarly work, which includes technical diagrams and cites 12 authoritative sources including AWS documentation, Microsoft Azure architecture patterns, and peer-reviewed research publications, was written for learned professionals in the field of distributed systems and cloud engineering.

The article explores sophisticated technical concepts including event sourcing and CQRS patterns in distributed systems, real-time processing architectures, Saga Pattern implementation, security considerations in distributed systems, and integration of AI and edge computing in cloud architectures. Through this publication, Mr. Kumar demonstrates his ability to contribute scholarly work to his professional community, presenting complex technical concepts and architectural patterns that require advanced knowledge in cloud engineering and distributed systems. The article's technical depth and inclusion of real-world implementations from major technology companies like PayPal, Netflix, and Amazon Web Services further establishes its scholarly nature and practical relevance to the field.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's published articles in BestForAndroid, please see:

- 72. **Exhibit H1:** Publication bibliography documenting four technology articles published between 2023-2025 across various online platforms including Hackread, The AI Journal, BisInfotech, and BestForAndroid, covering topics such as distributed front-end architecture, AI automation in development, composable web application architecture, and hyper-scalable web systems.
- 73. **Exhibit I1:** Technical article by Mr. Kumar titled "Advancing Hyper-Scalable Web Systems Through Event-Driven Distributed Architecture," published on BestForAndroid on May 5, 2024.

c. Publications in The AI Journal

Mr. Kumar has authored a significant scholarly article in The AI Journal, demonstrating his expertise in cloud engineering and software development automation. His publication, "Pioneering AI and Automation in Front-End Development and Architecture," presents a comprehensive analysis of AI-driven development tools, cloud migration strategies, and modern software architecture principles. Written for learned persons in the field of software engineering and cloud computing, this scholarly work explores critical technological developments including AI-powered code generation, automated testing frameworks, and CI/CD processes.

The article demonstrates deep technical expertise through its analysis of emerging tools like GitHub Copilot, HopeAI, and the Model Context Protocol (MCP). Its scholarly nature is further evidenced by the inclusion of detailed case studies and scholarly references that substantiate the findings. Mr. Kumar incorporates comprehensive technical analysis and industry automation trends, alongside real-world implementation case studies that showcase productivity improvements in enterprise environments.

As the sole author of this publication, Mr. Kumar was recognized for his credentials as a Principal Software Engineer with extensive experience in software architecture, scalable systems design, and distributed computing, establishing his authority to contribute scholarly work in his field of endeavor.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's published articles in The AI Journal, please see:

- 74. **Exhibit H1:** Publication bibliography documenting four technology articles published between 2023 and 2025 on various online platforms, including topics such as "Architecting Resilient Distributed Front-Ends Accessibility Design," "Pioneering AI and Automation in Front-End Development and Architecture," "Composable Architecture for Scalable Web Applications Using Design Systems and AI Components," and "Hyper-Scalable Web Systems."
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75. **Exhibit J1:** Research paper by Mr. Kumar titled "Pioneering AI and Automation in Front-End Development and Architecture," published in The AI Journal.

d. Publications in BISinfotech

Mr. Kumar has authored scholarly articles in his field of Cloud Engineering, contributing advanced technical knowledge through publications in respected industry platforms. His article "Composable Architecture for Scalable Web Applications Using Design Systems and AI Components," published in BISinfotech on January 10, 2025, presents sophisticated analysis and implementation strategies for scalable web architectures. This scholarly work, written for learned practitioners in software architecture and cloud engineering, includes comprehensive technical documentation through code examples, architectural diagrams, and implementation methodologies. The academic rigor of Mr. Kumar's publication is evidenced by its six referenced sources and quantifiable results from real-world implementations, demonstrating a 30% improvement in page performance, successful scaling to over 200,000 users without performance degradation, and cost savings exceeding \$100,000 through component reuse. Through this publication, Mr. Kumar has contributed valuable scholarly insights to ongoing challenges in web application scalability and presented advanced solutions for modular front-end architectures, design systems, and AI-assisted development.

For Mr. Kumar's published articles in BISinfotech magazine, please see:

76. **Exhibit H1:** Publication bibliography documenting Mr. Kumar's four scholarly articles on cloud engineering topics published across professional technology platforms from December 2023 to September 2025.
77. **Exhibit K1:** Technical article by Mr. Kumar titled "Composable Architecture for Scalable Web Applications Using Design Systems and AI Components" published in BISinfotech on January 10, 2025.

Mr. Kumar's scholarly articles published in respected technology platforms like HACKREAD, BestForAndroid, The AI Journal, and BISinfotech have made significant contributions to the field of Cloud Engineering, demonstrating his expertise and influence in the field. The discussion above and the documents contained herein demonstrate by a preponderance of the evidence that Mr. Kumar meets the criteria set forth in 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(vi).

4. Evidence that the Beneficiary has performed in a leading or critical role for organizations or establishments that have a distinguished reputation

AT&T Services Inc. stands as one of the largest and most distinguished telecommunications providers in the United States, demonstrating its eminent reputation through substantial market presence, technological leadership, and industry influence. With a fiber network passing over 30 million consumer and business locations and serving more than 17 million internet subscribers nationwide, AT&T maintains a dominant position in the telecommunications sector across urban, suburban, and rural markets. The organization's financial strength is evidenced by its impressive quarterly performance, generating \$4.4 billion in free cash flow, while its ambitious expansion plans target reaching 60 million locations by 2030, demonstrating sustained growth and market leadership.

AT&T's technological innovation and industry leadership are validated through its strategic partnership with Microsoft Azure, which has strengthened Azure's credibility in enterprise

telecommunications and opened opportunities for cutting-edge developments in 5G edge computing. The organization sets benchmarks for major competitors including Verizon, T-Mobile, and Vodafone, particularly in areas of cloud adoption and digital transformation. AT&T's influence extends to establishing industry standards, as demonstrated by its pioneering role in implementing FCC-mandated transparency measures that encourage broader industry adoption of consumer trust practices.

The organization's distinguished status is further reinforced by its comprehensive security and compliance infrastructure, maintaining alignment with multiple industry frameworks including ISO, SOC, FedRAMP, and HIPAA standards. AT&T's successful convergence of services, evidenced by 40% of fiber customers also choosing wireless services, has established new benchmarks in service delivery that have forced major competitors including Comcast, Spectrum, and Verizon to reevaluate their business models. This market influence, combined with AT&T's role in supporting federal priorities through programs like the Affordable Connectivity Program, solidifies its position as a distinguished organization that shapes the telecommunications industry's future.

Within this prominent organization, Mr. Kumar serves in a critical role as Principal Software Engineer, where he leads strategic transformation initiatives that fundamentally impact AT&T's technological infrastructure and business outcomes. In this capacity, he spearheads major technical projects including BSSE transformation, Digital transformation, and federal compliance initiatives, while establishing engineering excellence standards across the organization.

Mr. Kumar's critical contributions are evidenced by the measurable impact of his leadership on organizational efficiency and cost reduction. His architectural leadership in the Digital App Migration to Azure project achieved a 36% reduction in monthly infrastructure costs from \$2.1 million to \$1.35 million, while reducing operational staffing requirements by 50% and improving deployment efficiency by 75%. These improvements have positioned AT&T at the forefront of cloud adoption in the telecommunications industry.

The organization has repeatedly recognized Mr. Kumar's critical role through multiple Connection Awards, exceptional performance ratings, and most recently, his promotion to Principal Software Engineer in July 2025. This promotion, accompanied by a substantial compensation package of \$183,010.59 plus an annual bonus target of \$23,791.38, reflects AT&T's recognition of his critical contributions. In his elevated position, Mr. Kumar continues to drive technological innovation through initiatives such as the organization-wide AI adoption program aimed at increasing developer productivity by 15%, while establishing and maintaining engineering excellence standards that require 90% code coverage and 80% test automation across AT&T's technical operations.

For documentation demonstrating Mr. Kumar's critical and leading roles in distinguished cloud engineering organizations, please see:

78. **Exhibit L1:** Product launch documentation for AT&T Internet Air showcasing web sales capabilities and online purchasing processes, with internal launch on November 14th and external launch on January 23rd, 2023.
 79. **Exhibit L2:** AT&T internal email showing Q2 2025 earnings results with \$4.4 billion in free cash flow, 30+ million fiber locations, and expansion plans demonstrating the company's distinguished reputation in telecommunications.
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80. **Exhibit L3:** Internal AT&T announcement regarding the launch of "AT&T Internet Air," a new product offering developed through the Business Systems Solutions Evolution (BSSE) program.
 81. **Exhibit L4:** Internal AT&T communication documenting the successful launch of AT&T Internet Air, a new fixed wireless product on BSSE platform, as part of the company's 2023 strategic objectives.
 82. **Exhibit L5:** Documentation establishing AT&T's distinguished reputation through its strategic Microsoft Azure partnership, major telecommunications infrastructure projects, and retail collaborations with industry leaders including Costco.
 83. **Exhibit L6:** Certificate of Achievement from AT&T recognizing participation in a winning Innovation Jam team that developed an innovative solution for fiber sales data issues.
 84. **Exhibit L7:** Award confirmation documenting Mr. Kumar's third-place achievement in AT&T's Innovation Jam competition for developing fiber sales solutions.
 85. **Exhibit L8:** Award certificate and documentation of Mr. Kumar's \$3,000 AT&T Connection Award recognizing his critical leadership role in high-priority strategic initiatives within the Digital Web Engineering organization.
 86. **Exhibit L9:** Award confirmation from AT&T recognizing Mr. Kumar's innovative multi-match addresses solution that improved customer service outcomes and increased revenue for the distinguished telecommunications company.
 87. **Exhibit L10:** AT&T Connection Award certificate recognizing Mr. Kumar's critical leadership in coordinating cross-functional teams for the AT&T Internet Air launch and Azure cloud migration.
 88. **Exhibit L11:** Employment verification from AT&T Services, Inc. confirming Mr. Kumar's Principal Software Engineering position with annual compensation exceeding \$206,000, demonstrating the critical nature of his role at the distinguished telecommunications company.
 89. **Exhibit L12:** Documentation of a Principal Software Engineer job posting at AT&T, including job description details, requirements, and company information.
 90. **Exhibit L13:** Organizational chart demonstrating Mr. Kumar's Principal Software Engineering position alongside C-level executives in the company's leadership structure.
 91. **Exhibit L14:** Salary documentation showing Mr. Kumar's progression to Principal Software Engineer with compensation reaching \$183,010.59, evidencing his critical technical leadership role.
 92. **Exhibit L15:** An organizational chart from AT&T displaying the hierarchical structure with an Associate Director position overseeing multiple engineering and quality assurance roles including Lead System Engineer, Principal Software Engineer, and Senior Quality Assurance positions.
 93. **Exhibit L16:** AT&T performance review documenting Mr. Kumar's critical leadership role as Lead Software Engineering at Management Level 2, including his exceptional performance ratings and management of strategic technical initiatives.
 94. **Exhibit L17:** Performance review documenting Mr. Kumar's critical leadership role as Lead Software Engineer at AT&T, where he delivered regulatory compliance projects and led technical modernization initiatives.
 95. **Exhibit L18:** AT&T promotion notification for Mr. Kumar to Principal Software Engineering position, recognizing his technical expertise and leadership capabilities.
 96. **Exhibit L19:** Performance review documenting Mr. Kumar's critical role as Principal Software Engineer at AT&T, where he leads strategic transformation initiatives, establishes organizational engineering excellence standards, and spearheads AI adoption programs.
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97. **Exhibit L20:** Employment record documenting Mr. Kumar's career progression to Principal Software Engineer at AT&T Services, a leading U.S. telecommunications company.
98. **Exhibit L21:** Recruitment email from AT&T, a major telecommunications company, congratulating the beneficiary on receiving a job offer in March 2022.
99. **Exhibit L22:** Documentation of AT&T Services Inc.'s distinguished reputation as a leading global telecom operator and evidence of Mr. Kumar's critical leadership roles as Lead Software Engineering/Architect on three major technical projects that delivered substantial cost savings and set industry benchmarks.
100. **Exhibit L23:** Employment verification from AT&T Services Inc. documenting Mr. Kumar's critical leadership role as Lead Software Engineer architecting major telecommunications projects with nationwide impact serving over 1 million customers.
101. **Exhibit L24:** Employment verification from AT&T Services Inc. documenting Mr. Kumar's critical roles as Architect/Lead Engineer across multiple high-impact projects at one of the largest telecommunications providers serving over 17 million internet subscribers.

The discussion above and the documents contained herein demonstrate by a preponderance of the evidence that Mr. Kumar meets the criteria set forth in 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(viii) through his critical roles in advancing cloud engineering initiatives at distinguished organizations.

5. Evidence that the Beneficiary has commanded a high salary or other significantly high remuneration for services, in relation to others in the field

a. Principal Software Engineer at AT&T Services, Inc.

Mr. Kumar's extraordinary abilities in cloud engineering are reflected in his substantial compensation at AT&T Services, Inc. In his current role as Principal Software Engineer in Bothell, Washington, Mr. Kumar commands a base salary of \$183,010.59, supplemented by a significant Success Bonus component of 13%, bringing his total target compensation to \$206,801.97 annually. This compensation package is documented through official AT&T Services, Inc. HR records and current pay stubs. His compensation history demonstrates a pattern of sustained high earnings, as evidenced by his W-2 documentation showing annual wages of \$155,063.75 in 2024 and \$145,927.69 in 2023. This steady increase in compensation reflects his growing expertise and value in the field of cloud engineering. Additionally, his current position's compensation grade of "Core US22-N3" within AT&T's structured framework further demonstrates his distinguished professional standing within the organization.

To properly contextualize Mr. Kumar's compensation within industry standards, we have analyzed data from multiple authoritative government sources. The FLC, BLS, and CareerOneStop provide specific wage statistics for Software Developers, which accurately reflects Mr. Kumar's role as a Principal Software Engineer. Based on the job descriptions and similar duties listed on these websites, we utilize this title to compare wages from these government salary sources to Mr. Kumar's base salary. For Bothell, Washington (King County), the comparative salary statistics are as follows:

Per the Occupational Employment Statistics (FLC), the highest salary bracket (Level 4 wage) based on advanced skills and diversified knowledge for Software Developers in King County is \$171,891 per year. The U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics states that Software Developers in the 90th percentile nationwide earn approximately \$168,570 per year. Data from CareerOneStop (sponsored by the U.S.

Department of Labor) indicates that the highest salary bracket for Software Developers is \$173,430 in Washington State and \$168,570 nationwide.

Mr. Kumar's current base salary of \$183,010.59 exceeds the highest wage levels reported by all three government salary sources, placing him above the top 10% of highest-paid professionals in his field, both regionally and nationally. His base salary alone surpasses the FLC Level 4 wage for King County by approximately 6.5%, the BLS 90th percentile nationwide figure by 8.6%, and the Washington State highest bracket by 5.5%. These comparisons clearly demonstrate that Mr. Kumar commands a salary substantially higher than that of the vast majority of professionals in his field, further evidencing his extraordinary ability in cloud engineering.

For documentation of Mr. Kumar's significant compensation as Principal Software Engineer at AT&T Services, Inc., please see:

102. **Exhibit M1:** W-2 tax form documenting Mr. Kumar's \$155,063.75 annual compensation from AT&T Services, Inc. in 2024.
103. **Exhibit M2:** IRS Form W-2 documenting Mr. Kumar's 2023 annual compensation of \$145,927.69 as a Principal Software Engineer at AT&T Services, Inc.
104. **Exhibit M3:** AT&T Services, Inc. official HR documentation showing Mr. Kumar's annual compensation of \$206,801.97 as Principal Software Engineer, effective July 16, 2025.
105. **Exhibit M4:** AT&T Services, Inc. pay stub documenting Mr. Kumar's annual salary of \$183,010.59 as Principal Software Engineer in Bothell, Washington.

Based on his compensation as Principal Software Engineer at AT&T Services, Inc. and the prevailing wage data presented above, Mr. Kumar's total remuneration substantially exceeds that of peers in his respective position and geography. The discussion above and the documents contained herein demonstrate by a preponderance of the evidence that Mr. Kumar meets the criteria set forth in 8 C.F.R. § 204.5(h)(3)(ix).

IV. FINAL MERITS ANALYSIS

In accordance with the Kazarian opinion, the second step of the two-part approach is a final merits determination that considers all of the evidence in the context of whether the Beneficiary meets the required level of high achievement and sustained international reputation in the field. The aggregated evidence establishes that the Beneficiary not only meets at least three of the regulatory criteria, but also that he has been recognized internationally as outstanding in his field of expertise.

If a petitioner has submitted the requisite evidence, USCIS determines whether the evidence demonstrates both a "level of expertise indicating that the individual is one of that small percentage who have risen to the very top of the field of endeavor," 8 C.F.R. §204.5(h)(2), and "that the alien has sustained national or international acclaim and that his or her achievements have been recognized in the field of expertise." 8 C.F.R. §204.5(h)(3). Only foreign nationals whose achievements have garnered "sustained national or international acclaim" are eligible for an "extraordinary ability" visa. 8 U.S.C. § 1153(b)(1)(A)(i). Kazarian, 596 F.3d at 1034.

The record supports that the Beneficiary's recognized achievements satisfy a minimum of three regulatory criteria:

106. **Membership in Associations** as SAS Eminent Fellow Member in the Scholars Academic and Scientific Society, a selective designation requiring outstanding achievement
107. **Judging Work of Others** as peer reviewer for prestigious international conferences and verified judge for technology innovation projects and technical presentations
108. **Scholarly Authorship** of four technical articles published in specialized technology platforms demonstrating advanced expertise in cloud engineering
109. **Leading or Critical Roles** as Principal Software Engineer at AT&T, leading strategic initiatives including AT&T Internet Air and cloud migration projects
110. **High Salary** with progressive compensation increases reaching \$206,801.97 total target compensation in 2025 as Principal Software Engineer

Mr. Kumar has sustained national and international acclaim in cloud engineering, as evidenced by his continuous progression of achievements and recognition from industry-leading organizations. As Principal Software Engineer at AT&T, one of the world's largest telecommunications companies, he has demonstrated extraordinary ability through his architectural leadership of mission-critical initiatives, including the AT&T Internet Air platform that now serves over 650,000 customers nationwide. His standing as a distinguished expert is validated by his selection for prestigious technical leadership roles, including Session Chair for the IEEE International Conference on Information Technology (ICITEICS 2025) and peer reviewer for multiple international conferences including ICAIN-2025 and RSCSM 2025. His designation as a SAS Eminent Fellow Member further affirms his elevated status within the international academic and scientific community. This recognition is reinforced by multiple Connection Awards, "Exceeds" performance ratings, and progressive compensation increases reaching \$206,801.97 in 2025, reflecting his position among the top professionals in his field.

The impact of his expertise is quantifiably demonstrated through achievements at AT&T, where his architectural innovations have resulted in a 36% reduction in infrastructure costs through cloud migration initiatives, 40% improvement in application performance, and 30% increase in conversion rates for critical business applications. His continued contributions through technical publications in professional platforms between 2023-2025 showcase his ongoing role in advancing cloud engineering practices and methodologies. Collectively, this evidence establishes sustained acclaim and confirms his position among the small percentage of individuals who have risen to the very top of the field of cloud engineering.

Mr. Kumar's entry will substantially benefit the United States through his continued leadership in strengthening critical digital infrastructure and advancing cloud engineering innovation in the telecommunications sector. His work at AT&T directly supports national priorities for expanding broadband access and modernizing digital infrastructure. His development of the CAAS platform has enabled major U.S. retailers like Costco and BJ's to provision AT&T services, creating new distribution channels that support domestic business growth. Beyond direct technical achievements, his leadership in implementing AI-driven development practices, which improved team productivity by 20%, demonstrates his ability to advance U.S. technological competitiveness through practical innovation. As a technical mentor and leader who influences hiring strategies at AT&T, he actively contributes to developing domestic talent in cloud engineering and telecommunications technology, areas strategically important to maintaining America's leadership in digital innovation.

If this petition is granted, Mr. Kumar will continue his innovative work in cloud engineering as Principal Software Engineer at AT&T, where he will advance critical initiatives in distributed systems architecture and cloud platform development. He will:

111. Lead the expansion of the AT&T Internet Air platform, building upon its current success serving over 650,000 customers;
112. Architect and implement cloud migration strategies, leveraging his expertise to further reduce infrastructure costs and improve system efficiency;
113. Design and develop hyper-scalable distributed systems for AT&T's broadband and wireless services;
114. Advance the implementation of AI-powered development tools and cloud-based solutions across AT&T's technology stack;
115. Guide technical strategy and mentor engineering teams in cloud architecture best practices; and,
116. Continue contributing to the field through conference participation, technical publications, and peer review activities.

These activities directly align with Mr. Kumar's established area of extraordinary ability in cloud engineering, ensuring his continued impact in this critical field.

After 3+ criteria are met, USCIS must offer specific and substantiated reasoning to contradict this objective demonstration that the eligibility standard is satisfied, to at least the mere 51% preponderance threshold. *Buletini v. INS*, 860 F.Supp. 1222 (E.D. Mich. 1994); *United States v. Cardozo-Fonseca*, 480 U.S. 421 (1987).

Please note that the controlling preponderance standard applies equally to the totality determination by USCIS, which is made on the entire submission to avoid inconsistent or arbitrary and capricious findings. *Chursov v. Miller*, 1:18-CV-02886-PKC (S.D. NY 2019); *Muni v. INS*, 891 F. Supp. 440 at 445 (N.D. Ill. 1995).

Therefore, the totality of evidence demonstrates that Mr. Kumar has achieved sustained national and international acclaim in Cloud Engineering through his exceptional technical innovations, architectural leadership, and transformative contributions to enterprise-scale cloud solutions, firmly establishing his position among the small percentage of experts who have risen to the top of this field and qualifying him for classification as an individual of extraordinary ability under the EB-1A category.

V. CONCLUSION

The submitted evidence shows, by a preponderance of the evidence, that Mr. Kumar is an alien of extraordinary ability in the field of Cloud Engineering. Mr. Kumar intends to continue his work in Cloud Engineering in the United States. For all the reasons set forth herein, we respectfully request the approval of this petition.

Thank you for your time and for your consideration of this petition. Please do not hesitate to contact us if you require any further documentation.
